Duolingo

Duolingo runs 466 total ads with 3 unique captions, relying entirely on mascot branding and short app screen demos.

THE ONE THING TO KNOW

5 ads, 5 different creatives, 3 captions. Score these ads on copy and most of them tie. So the workflow watched every video and judged the creative, not the caption.

5	466	5	3	1
ads scored	active ads in library	unique creatives	unique captions	Facebook pages

Source	https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?active_status=active&ad_type=all&country=IN&is_targeted_country=false&media_type=all&q=%22Duolingo%22…
Sample	Top 5 active ads by Meta's impression sort · 0 duplicates removed
Pipeline	n8n · Apify · Gemini (video understanding) · deterministic scoring
Prepared by	Tharani M

01 — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What the library is telling us

Duolingo runs 466 total ads with 3 unique captions, relying entirely on mascot branding and short app screen demos.

- Out of 466 active ads reported by the library, our sample of 5 shows an average creative score of 63.4 and an average market score of 67.
- Ad 1358473513046877 scores highest in our framework at index 79.8, driven by a 6-second app screen demo.
- 0 of the 5 sampled ads use a quantified outcome, urgency, comparison, objection handling, before-after transformation, or customer story.
- 5 of 5 ads feature sound-off ready formatting, but none of the ads in the sample include a spoken CTA.

BEST AD	AVG CREATIVE	AVG MARKET SIGNAL	PRODUCT ON SCREEN	SOUND-OFF READY
79.8	63.4	67.0	0s	100%
Ad Strength Index	of 100	of 100	median first reveal	burned-in captions

Portfolio, as observed

Active ads reported	466
Pages running ads (sample)	Duolingo
Dynamic Creative share	2/5
Caption languages	English
Destinations	play.google.com (5)
Placements	facebook, instagram, audience_network, messenger, threads
Template leaks	2 ads show raw `{{product.name}}` placeholders in the library

How to read this report

`OBSERVED` seen, heard or scraped directly.
`INFERRED` Gemini's judgement, always phrased as "likely".
`ESTIMATED` a score computed in n8n from the two above.

The ranking is estimated creative effectiveness from observable characteristics. It is not campaign performance — the Ad Library does not expose CTR, CPI or ROAS.

Where the ads land



02 — METHODOLOGY

How the winner is picked

Gemini describes and grades. n8n does the maths. The same inputs always give the same ranking.

01 Ad Library URL → 02 Apify scrape → 03 Normalize · dedupe · fingerprint → 04 Gemini watches each video → 05 Validate / repair JSON → 06 Score in code → 07 Rank + quadrant → 08 Strategist memo → 09 PDF

Creative Score · 0–100 ESTIMATED

Hook	20%
Clarity	15%
Value prop	15%
Offer	15%
CTA	10%
Specificity	10%
Creative angle	10%
Conversion intent	5%

Each dimension is a 0–10 grade from Gemini against a written rubric with anchors. Weighted sum × 10. Missing grades are imputed at 5 and flagged.

Market Signal · 0–100 OBSERVED

Impression rank in sample	50%
Longevity (full at 30 days)	30%
Distribution (placements + clones)	20%

Advertisers kill ads that lose money. An ad Meta ranks high on impressions, that has survived for weeks, or that has been re-uploaded as a clone is a revealed preference — the closest public proxy to "this one works".

```
Ad Strength Index = 0.7 × Creative Score + 0.3 × Market Signal
```

Quadrants

Proven winner — above median on both. **Hidden gem** — strong creative the market hasn't backed yet: give it budget. **Study this** — the market likes it more than the rubric does: find what the rubric misses. **Retire** — below median on both.

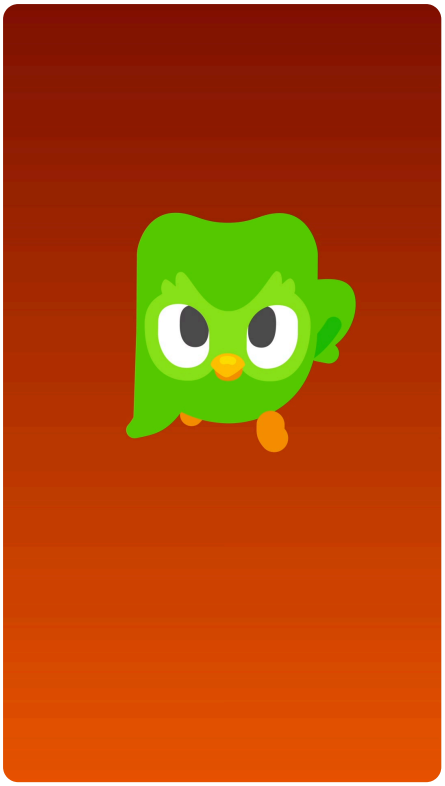
Sampling & cleaning

10 rows scraped, 0 exact duplicates removed (same ad id or identical video assets), top 5 kept in Meta's order. Video asset ids and durations were decoded from the CDN urls to separate ads that share a caption. 3 × watched video, 2 × read image.

03 — BEST AD IN THE SAMPLE

Ad 1358473513046877 — learn a language with 10 minutes per day

Strongest ad in the sampled set based on our creative/conversion scoring framework, blended with observable market signals.



View in Ad Library ↗

Duolingo
Live since 2026-07-01 · 97 days
6s video · English

RANK 1 OF 5

79.8

Ad Strength Index

Creative	Market	Quadrant
74.5	92.0	Proven winner

Hook	7	20%	Clarity	9	15%
Value prop	8	15%	Offer	7	15%
CTA	8	10%	Specificity	6	10%
Creative angle	7	10%	Conversion intent	7	5%

HOOK OBSERVED BENEFIT

> learn a language with 10 minutes per day

FIRST 3 SECONDS OBSERVED

Green owl mascot face zooming in with upbeat music and a bouncing motion

BODY OBSERVED

Presents Duolingo as the world's number one learning app for free language education with interactive lessons.

CTA OBSERVED

Said/shown: **none** · Button: **Install now**

Why it wins

Instant visual identification via the green mascot
Ad 1358473513046877 opens with the green owl mascot face zooming in with upbeat music and a bouncing motion.

Low friction value proposition in the first three seconds
On-screen text in ad 1358473513046877 reads 'learn a language with 10 minutes per day' with a hook score of 7 out of 10.

High product visibility and clarity
Ad 1358473513046877 achieves a clarity score of 9 and product visibility of 9 by displaying App Store and Google Play badges alongside the logo.

Steal this

- Use the iconic green mascot in the first three seconds of every video creative.
- Pair a low time commitment of 10 minutes a day directly with the core product UI.
- Keep total video duration under 6 seconds for high-frequency brand reminders.

Biggest leak INFERRED

Does not show actual gameplay or lesson interaction inside the app, relying purely on branding and text.

Test next

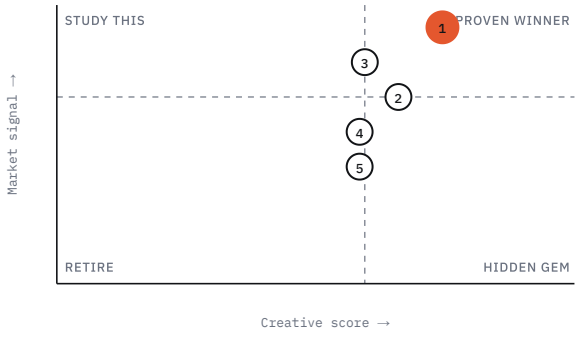
Test a 2-second clip of an actual interactive lesson question to demonstrate how engaging the 10 minutes feel.

04 — AD SCOREBOARD

All scored ads, ranked

Sorted by Ad Strength Index. Ties break on creative score, then on Meta's own order.

#		AD	HOOK	HOOK	OFFER	CTA	CREATIVE	MARKET	INDEX
1		**1358473513046877** App screen demo · English · 6s	Benefit · learn a language with 10 minutes per day	7	7	8	74.5	92.0	**79.8** PROVEN WINNER
2		**2222173525022786** App screen demo · English · 21s	Curiosity · If you win, I'll eat my mustache.	7	5	5	66.0	67.0	**66.3** PROVEN WINNER
3		**872722692089728** animation · English and... · 5s	Benefit · I've been learning Spanish on Duolingo, for free.	7	4	3	59.5	79.5	**65.5** PROVEN WINNER
4		**1364532395612949** Static image · English	Question · ready to finally learn chess?	7	0	6	58.5	54.5	**57.3** RETIRE
5		**1021191287536143** Static image · English	Benefit · Start building your language fluency	7	0	6	58.5	42.0	**53.6** RETIRE



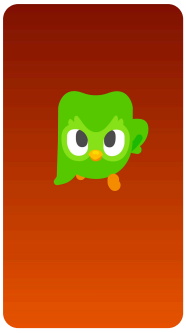
Reading the grid

Numbers are ranks. Dashed lines are the sample medians (creative 59.5, market 67.0).

05 — INDIVIDUAL AD ANALYSIS

Every ad, one card each

Hook, body and CTA as observed in the creative; target, angle and verdicts are Gemini's inference.



1358473513046877

AD #01 Duolingo · App screen demo · English · 6s · watched video

Index **79.8** Creative **74.5** Market **92.0** Proven winner caption shared ×2

HOOK · BENEFIT · 7/10

> learn a language with 10 minutes per day

CTA

none · "Install now"

OFFER

Free language learning app

BODY

Presents Duolingo as the world's number one learning app for free language education with interactive lessons.

ANGLE · LIKELY TARGET

Value and convenience driven animated demo — People wanting to learn a new language with limited daily time

PAIN → OUTCOME

Lack of time or money to learn a new language → Fluent or conversational in a new language through 10-minute daily lessons

WHY IT WORKS

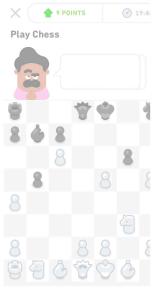
Instant brand recognition via the iconic green mascot combined with a clear, low-friction time commitment (10 minutes a day) stops the scroll effectively.

WEAKNESS

Does not show actual gameplay or lesson interaction inside the app, relying purely on branding and text.

RECOMMENDATION

Test a 2-second clip of an actual interactive lesson question to demonstrate how engaging the 10 minutes feel.



2222173525022786

AD #02 Duolingo · App screen demo · English · 21s · watched video

Index **66.3** Creative **66.0** Market **67.0** Proven winner caption shared ×2

HOOK · CURIOSITY · 7/10

> If you win, I'll eat my mustache.

CTA

none · "Install now"

OFFER

free

BODY

An animated match of Duolingo Chess where the user defeats the character Oscar, triggering a humorous defeat screen and Duolingo branding.

ANGLE · LIKELY TARGET

Gamified character interaction demo — Casual gamers, Duolingo users, chess beginners

PAIN → OUTCOME

Learning chess can be intimidating or boring → Learn chess easily and playfully through gamified bitesized matches

WHY IT WORKS

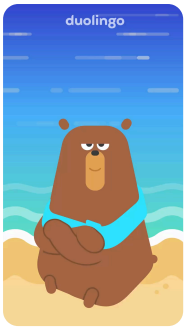
Character dialogue and personality ('If you win, I'll eat my mustache') hooks the viewer instantly with humor before introducing the new product feature.

WEAKNESS

The CTA is completely generic ('Play for free') and fails to explain how to get started with Duolingo Chess.

RECOMMENDATION

Test a stronger spoken or on-screen CTA highlighting the specific new feature right after the win moment.



872722692089728

AD #03 Duolingo · animation · English and Spanish · 5s · watched video

Index **65.5** Creative **59.5** Market **79.5** Proven winner

HOOK · BENEFIT · 7/10

> **I've been learning Spanish on Duolingo, for free.**

CTA

none · "Install now"

OFFER

free

BODY

The animated bear says a simple Spanish phrase '¡Me encanta la playa!' while standing on a beach.

ANGLE · LIKELY TARGET

Character animation testimonial — Adults interested in learning Spanish or languages for free

PAIN → OUTCOME

Language learning is often expensive or inaccessible → Learn a new language easily and for free

WHY IT WORKS

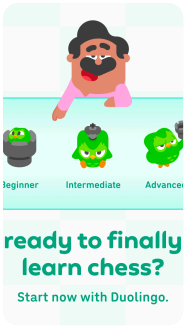
Using the recognizable brand style and mascot immediately signals Duolingo and delivers a fast, low-friction value proposition.

WEAKNESS

Zero product UI or gameplay shown, making it purely branding rather than conversion-driven.

RECOMMENDATION

Test adding 2 seconds of actual app UI showing a lesson completion to bridge brand awareness with product utility.



1364532395612949

AD #04 Duolingo · Static image · English · read image

Index **57.3** Creative **58.5** Market **54.5** Retire caption shared ×2

HOOK · QUESTION · 7/10

> **ready to finally learn chess?**

CTA

none · "Install now"

OFFER

none observed

BODY

Duolingo introduces chess learning with three distinct levels: Beginner, Intermediate, and Advanced, represented by the iconic green owl character interacting with chess pieces.

ANGLE · LIKELY TARGET

Brand expansion / New product feature announcement — Adults and students who want to learn chess but find it intimidating or haven't gotten around to it

PAIN → OUTCOME

Never having learned how to play chess despite wanting to → Mastering chess easily through bite-sized, gamified learning

WHY IT WORKS

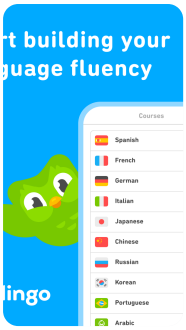
It instantly bridges a massive, universally recognized brand with a completely new vertical (chess), sparking immediate curiosity from anyone who has ever wanted to learn the game.

WEAKNESS

Lacks actual product UI or gameplay footage, relying entirely on illustrated brand graphics rather than showing what the in-app learning experience looks like.

RECOMMENDATION

Test a carousel or short video variant that displays 3 seconds of actual in-app chess puzzle gameplay to demonstrate the user experience.



1021191287536143

AD #05 Duolingo · Static image · English · read image

Index **53.6** Creative **58.5** Market **42.0** Retire caption shared ×2

HOOK · BENEFIT · 7/10

> **Start building your language fluency**

CTA

none · "Install now"

OFFER

none observed

BODY

A clear visual display of multiple popular language courses available within the app, reinforced by the brand mascot and a value-driven headline.

ANGLE · LIKELY TARGET

Product showcase with recognizable mascot — People interested in learning a new language casually or for travel.

PAIN → OUTCOME

Language learning apps can feel intimidating, expensive, or lacking in variety. → Gain fluency in a new language easily and for free.

WHY IT WORKS

Instant brand recognition via the mascot combined with an immediate visual demonstration of available language options.

WEAKNESS

Lacks a specific hook, urgency, or explicit offer to drive immediate app installation over competitors.

RECOMMENDATION

Test a variation that highlights a specific interactive lesson feature or a social proof stat (e.g., 'Join 50M learners').

06 — HOOK ANALYSIS

What happens in the first three seconds

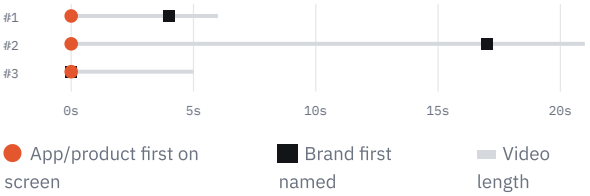
60% of hooks rely on a Benefit angle, led by phrases like 'learn a language with 10 minutes per day' and 'Start building your language fluency'. All recorded hooks in the sample score a uniform 7 out of 10.

Hook types



Average hook score 7.0/10.

Time to product OBSERVED



Median product reveal 0s · median brand mention 4s.

#	OPENING VISUAL	HOOK (ENGLISH)	TYPE	SCORE
1	Green owl mascot face zooming in with upbeat music and a bouncing motion	learn a language with 10 minutes per day	Benefit	7
2	Duolingo character Oscar with a mustache, speech bubble, and a Duolingo Chess interface showing game pieces	If you win, I'll eat my mustache.	Curiosity	7
3	An animated brown bear with arms crossed standing on a beach against a blue and yellow background with Duolin...	I've been learning Spanish on Duolingo, for free.	Benefit	7
4	Duolingo character pointing down towards chess difficulty levels with Duolingo owls inside chess pieces	ready to finally learn chess?	Question	7
5	Duolingo owl peeking from behind a smartphone displaying a course list of languages against a bright blue bac...	Start building your language fluency	Benefit	7

07 — CTA ANALYSIS

How each ad asks for the install

5 of 5 creatives never say or show what to do next verbally, and all 5 ads end on identical static install buttons without dynamic spoken direction.

BUTTON VARIETY
1
"Install now" ×5

SILENT CTAS
5/5
never say what to do next

AVG CTA SCORE
5.6
of 10 · offer 3.2

Offers observed



#	SAID / SHOWN IN THE CREATIVE	BUTTON	NOTE	CTA
1	none	Install now	Clear low-friction button with strong value word 'free'	8
2	none	Install now	Generic app store button with no urgency or scarcity.	5
3	none	Install now	The button is standard Meta CTA, but there is no spoken or on-screen CTA inside the 5-second video.	3
4	none	Install now	Standard app install CTA button matching Meta's native placement UI.	6
5	none	Install now	Standard app install CTA paired with a direct benefit-driven headline.	6

08 — CREATIVE PATTERNS

What this advertiser keeps doing

Mascot-Led Animation

Brand assets anchor the opening frame across animated formats.

Ad 1358473513046877 features the green owl mascot zooming in at 0s.

Absent Spoken CTA

Audio tracks rely entirely on instrumental music or character dialogue without directing the user's next action.

Ads 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5 all feature zero spoken CTAs.

Missing Proof Points

Creatives skip numerical evidence and transformation arcs.

0 of 5 ads use quantified outcomes, before-after states, or objection handling.

Short Duration Demo

Top scoring creatives keep runtime tight to maintain completion rates.

Ad 1358473513046877 runs for 6 seconds while ad 872722692089728 runs for 5 seconds.

Formats



Spoken language



Talent



Evidence grid — which ads use which lever OBSERVED

	Numbers	Social proof	Urgency	Comparison	Objections	Before/after	Learner story	Price on screen	App UI shown	Human face
#1	○	●	○	○	○	○	○	○	●	○
#2	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	●	●	○
#3	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
#4	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
#5	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	●	○
Total	**0**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**3**	**0**

09 — COMPETITIVE GAPS

What nobody in this sample is doing

Each gap starts from a count in the evidence grid, not from opinion.

01 Zero Quantified Outcomes

`0 of 5 ads use a number, timeline, salary, or score jump.`

Why it matters. Users need specific performance metrics to believe a learning app works.

Opportunity. Add exact day counts or vocabulary word milestones into the hook.

02 No Regional Language Creatives

`Sample covers no regional language; nothing in Telugu, Bengali, or Marathi.`

Why it matters. The Indian market responds strongly to local language hooks and contextual localization.

Opportunity. Translate top benefit hooks into regional Indian languages with English subtitles.

03 Absence of Competitor Comparison

`0 of 5 ads compare Duolingo against traditional tutors, coaching classes, or YouTube.`

Why it matters. Viewers need a direct reason to choose an app over human coaching.

Opportunity. Build a side-by-side comparison showing cost and time saved.

04 Lack of Objection Handling

`0 of 5 ads address common barriers like lack of time, fear of grammar, or feeling too old.`

Why it matters. Hesitant users drop off when their daily constraints are ignored.

Opportunity. Create an ad addressing the 'I am too busy for lessons' objection directly.

10 — THREE NEW AD CONCEPTS

Built on the gaps, not on the competitor's ads

CONCEPT 1 The Regional Classroom Test

exploits: Sample covers no regional language; nothing in Telugu, Bengali, Marathi | Reel / Short video

HOOK

> रोज सिर्फ 10 मिनट में अंग्रेजी सीखो

Learn English in just 10 minutes every day

ANGLE

Regional language accessibility

SCRIPT

1. 0-3s: Green mascot pointing to a phone screen with Hindi text overlay.
2. 3-10s: Screen recording showing a 10-second vocabulary matching exercise inside the app.
3. 10-20s: Close-up of app interface with streak counter ticking up to 30 days.
4. 20-25s: End card showing Google Play badge and download prompt.

CAPTION

Start your language streak today for free.

CTA

Install now

WHY IT COULD WORK

Native language text in the opening seconds captures attention from users scrolling in regional feeds.

MEASURE · KILL IF

Click-through rate · If CTR is below 0.8% after 3,000 impressions, pause.

CONCEPT 2 The Tutor Cost Comparison

exploits: None of the 5 ads use a comparison against the alternative (tutor, coaching class, YouTube) | Split-screen animation

HOOK

> **Private tutor costs 5000 rupees. Duolingo costs zero.**

ANGLE

Price and alternative comparison

SCRIPT

1. 0-3s: Split screen showing a heavy textbook on the left and Duolingo mascot on the right.
2. 3-10s: Text animation crossing out coaching fees and highlighting free app access.
3. 10-20s: Quick app demo showing lesson completion screen.
4. 20-25s: End screen with zero price callout.

CAPTION

Learn languages without paying for expensive classes.

CTA

Play for free

WHY IT COULD WORK

Direct financial comparison addresses value-conscious learners immediately.

MEASURE · KILL IF

App install conversion rate · If cost per install exceeds benchmark by 40%, kill.

CONCEPT 3

The Busy Schedule Proof

exploits: None of the 5 ads use objection handling (shy, no time, weak grammar, too old)

App screen demo with on-screen text

HOOK

> **Too busy for classes? Do one lesson during your commute.**

ANGLE

Objection handling for time constraints

SCRIPT

1. 0-3s: Text overlay on black background: 'Too busy for classes?'
2. 3-10s: Mascot appears with phone showing a quick 2-minute lesson in progress.
3. 10-20s: Graphic showing completion checkmark on a bus or train icon.
4. 20-25s: App Store download button with green mascot.

CAPTION

Fit language learning into your daily commute.

CTA

Install now

WHY IT COULD WORK

Directly tackles the lack of time objection within the first three seconds.

MEASURE · KILL IF

Video hook retention rate at 3s · If 3s view-through rate drops below 45%, stop test.

11 — FINAL RECOMMENDATIONS

What I would do on Monday

ACTION	WHY	EFFORT	IMPACT
Introduce quantified outcomes in hook text	Zero ads currently use numbers, timelines, or score jumps to drive interest.	Low	Med
Produce creative variations in regional Indian languages	The sampled top ads feature zero regional language representation.	Med	High
Add spoken CTAs to all video creatives	5 of 5 sampled ads omit verbal direction on what the user should do next.	Low	Med
Build comparison assets against traditional alternatives	No active ads pit the app against tutors, coaching classes, or YouTube.	Med	High

12 — DISCLAIMER & LIMITATIONS

The ranking represents estimated creative effectiveness based on observable ad characteristics. It is not based on private campaign performance data. The Meta Ad Library does not expose CTR, CPI, CPA, ROAS or spend for commercial ads in India.

- Sample: top 5 active ads by Meta's impression sort out of 466 reported. Patterns describe this sample, not the whole account.
- Creative grades come from Gemini against a fixed rubric; they are judgements and can vary slightly between runs. Weights, ranks, medians and gaps are deterministic.
- Market Signal uses public behaviour (sort order, run length, placements, clones) as a proxy for advertiser confidence. It can be wrong for new ads or ads paused for reasons unrelated to results.
- Dynamic Creative ads hold several variants; the first video variant was analysed. Creative URLs from Meta expire after a few days, so thumbnails in older copies of this report may not load.
- Strategist memo source: gemini. Generated 05 Oct 2026.